

Nova AI Cofounder V3 — Setup Guide

Page 1-3: What You're Getting

Nova AI Cofounder V3 is not a chatbot. It is an AI coworker that lives on your machine, works while you sleep, and handles the tasks you hate.

What makes this different?

- **Self-hosted** — Your data stays on your machine. No cloud subscription. No API bills unless you want them.
- **Autonomous** — Set it to L3+ and it executes tasks, cleans your inbox, posts to social, monitors projects — without waking you.
- **Customizable** — You define its personality, its boundaries, and what it's allowed to do. Raccoon, fox, owl, dragon, or custom.
- **Skill-based** — Add capabilities like WordPress publishing, Gmail cleanup, trade monitoring, social media posting. Install only what you need.

What you'll have after setup:

- An AI that knows your name, your projects, and your communication style
- Morning briefings with weather, calendar, and project status
- Automatic email spam cleanup
- Scheduled social media posts
- Project tracking with milestone reminders
- A growing memory of everything you've done together

Setup time: 30-45 minutes

Requirements: - Windows 10/11, macOS, or Linux - 8GB RAM minimum (16GB recommended for local AI model) - Python 3.11+ (installer will install if missing) - Internet connection (for initial download)

Page 4-8: Before You Start

Have ready:

1. **Gmail account with IMAP enabled** (optional but recommended)
2. Settings → Forwarding and POP/IMAP → Enable IMAP
3. myaccount.google.com/apppasswords → Generate app password
4. **Discord account** (optional, for bot integration)
5. You'll create a bot at discord.com/developers/applications
6. Copy the bot token during setup
7. **API key** (optional, if you want cloud model instead of local)
8. OpenAI, Anthropic, or Google AI
9. Local Ollama model is free and runs on your GPU
10. **WordPress sites** (optional, for content publishing)
11. Application password from each site's admin panel

Expected flow:

Run `install.ps1` → Answer prompts → Configure channels → Test first task → Done

If something goes wrong:

- Check `docs/troubleshooting.pdf` (included in download)
- Post in Discord #nova-help: <https://discord.gg/XxDCEwg7Wh>
- No paid support, but the community helps

Page 9-18: Step-by-Step Setup

Step 1: Download and Extract

1. Purchase from Gumroad (link in your receipt)
2. Download `nova-cofounder-v3.zip`
3. Extract to a folder (e.g., `C:\Tools\Nova` or `~/nova`)

Step 2: Run the Installer

Windows (PowerShell as Admin):

```
cd nova-cofounder-v3\setup
.\install.ps1
```

Options: - `install.ps1 -Docker` — Use Docker containers (advanced) - `install.ps1 -Model api` — Use cloud API instead of local Ollama - `install.ps1 -SkipIntake` — Skip the onboarding (do it later)

Step 3: Prerequisites Check

The installer will check for and install if missing: - Python 3.11+ (via winget on Windows, brew on macOS) - Git (for skill updates) - Nodejs (for OpenClaw Gateway) - Ollama (for local AI model, unless using API)

You'll see green checkmarks as each passes. If something fails, the script will tell you how to fix it.

Step 4: OpenClaw Gateway Install

The script downloads and installs the OpenClaw Gateway — the runtime that connects you to the AI model, skills, and channels.

Default install location: - Windows: `%USERPROFILE%\openclaw\gateway` - macOS/Linux: `~/.openclaw/gateway`

Step 5: Channel Configuration

The installer will ask about channels one by one:

Discord: - Enter your bot token (or press Enter to skip) - If you have a guild ID, enter it (or I'll help you find it)

Telegram: - Enter bot token from @BotFather (or skip)

WhatsApp: - A QR code will be shown to link your phone (or skip)

"Just local for now?" - Press Enter through all channel prompts - You can add channels later via `openclaw config`

Step 6: Core Skills Install

The script auto-installs essential skills: - **clawhub** — skill marketplace - **browser-automation** — web scraping, form filling - **memory-hygiene** — keeps memory clean and fast - **self-improving-agent** — learns from mistakes - **duckdb-en** — data analysis - **taskflow** — multi-step task management

Then it asks about optional skills: - gmail-cleanup (spam sweep + inbox triage) - wordpress-pro (publishing automation) - ai-social-media-content (post generation) - upload-post (posting to TikTok, IG, X, etc.)

Type `y` for each you want, `N` to skip.

Step 7: Docker Setup (Optional)

If you used `-Docker`, the script: - Checks Docker Desktop is installed - Copies `docker-compose.yml` to your workspace - Prints: `Run "docker-compose up" to start isolated services`

Docker containers run: Gateway, Redis (short-term memory), LanceDB (vector memory).

Step 8: Launch Intake

After install completes, you'll see:

```
Nova is installed. Run 'openclaw nova-intake' to start Day 1.
```

Run it. This starts the 7-day onboarding. Day 1 takes 5 minutes.

Page 19-24: Making It Yours

Customize SOUL.md (Personality)

File location: `~/openclaw/workspace/SOUL.md`

Edit with any text editor. Key sections: - **Identity** — Name, creature, emoji - **Approach** — How I think through problems - **Execution** — When to ask vs when to act - **Boundaries** — What I'm allowed to do unsupervised

Example customization:

```
## Identity
- **Name:** Athena
- **Creature:** Owl-spirit AI
- **Vibe:** Precise, thoughtful, no fluff
- **Emoji:** 🦉
```

Add Your Projects

File: `~/openclaw/workspace/memory/projects.md`

List active projects. I reference this every session:

```
## Active Projects
- **Website Redesign** — WordPress refresh for client X
- **TradeBot V2** — Solana memecoin trading automation
- **Nova V3 Launch** — AI cofounder product packaging
```

Set Autonomy Level

Run: `/level` in chat

Or edit `SAFETY.md` directly:

```
# Safety Invariants
Autonomy Level: L3 (Execute most, notify after)

Hard Limits:
- Never spend more than $50 without asking
- Never send emails to new contacts without preview
- Never post to social media without approval
- Trash > delete for all file operations
```

Add Custom Cron Jobs

Example: Check a website every hour for changes

```
openclaw cron add --name "price-check" --schedule "0 * * * *" --command "python check_pric
```

Page 25-28: Common Issues

"Python not found"

Fix: The installer should auto-install Python via winget. If it fails: 1. Download from python.org 2. Check "Add Python to PATH" during install 3. Re-run `install.ps1`

"Ollama model too slow"

Fix: You're running a large model on CPU. Options: 1. Use a smaller model: `ollama pull deepseek-v4-flash` 2. Use API mode: Re-run installer with `-Model api` 3. Add a dedicated GPU (AMD or NVIDIA, 8GB+ VRAM)

"Discord bot won't connect"

Fix: 1. Check token is correct (no extra spaces) 2. Bot must be invited to a server with permissions 3. Gateway must be running: `openclaw gateway status`

"Cron jobs not running"

Fix: 1. Check gateway is running: `openclaw gateway status` 2. Check cron list: `openclaw cron list` 3. Check logs: `~/openclaw/gateway/logs/`

"Memory feels bloated"

Fix: Run memory hygiene:

```
openclaw skill run memory-hygiene
```

Or manually review `memory/YYYY-MM-DD.md` files and archive old ones.

Page 29-30: What Now?

Daily Commands

- `openclaw chat` — Start a conversation
- `/project add [name]` — Add a project
- `/project status [name]` — Check on something
- `/delegate [task]` — Assign a task, get back later
- `/level` — Check or change autonomy

Weekly Rituals

- **Monday:** Skill update check (`clawhub update --all`)
- **Wednesday:** Memory review (archive old daily logs)
- **Sunday:** Autonomy level review (should I upgrade?)

Community

- **Discord:** <https://discord.gg/XxDCEwg7Wh>
- **#nova-help:** Ask setup questions
- **#showcase:** Share your Nova configuration

Upgrade Path

- **V3 → V4** (Q4 2026): Multi-agent teams, voice interface, mobile app
- **Skills:** New skills added to ClawHub weekly
- **Blog:** aicofounderstack.com for tips and case studies

You're set. Welcome to having an AI coworker.

